

Tech-Com DSC-520 5.0 MP

An unexpected performer

The spec-sheet for this camera is pretty much standard for most compact digicams—3x optical zoom, coupled with 4x digital zoom. (The latter is useless in our opinion, but it's an important on-paper spec to some.) The camera's built



rather well—nearly all Tech-Com digital cameras we've tested are. It feels solid to hold as well.

You just can't go wrong with black and silver as a colour combination, and the DSC-520, while being far from a stunner, does look nice with an all-black face and rear and side trim silver all-round. The body doesn't pick up fingerprints—very nice again.

Button ergonomics are good. The shoot button has a distinctive half-press for auto-focus. As opposed to some cameras we've tested, here you can actually tell by the tactile feedback that the camera is auto-focusing, without having to look at any

indicators. Incidentally, there's no viewfinder: you'll have to manage with the 2-inch, 1,15,000 pixel LCD—which does get grainy, especially in dimly-lit conditions, and at the end of the lens zoom. The menu layout is pretty simple—all the options are accessible under a single menu. With four white balance modes and manual ISO ratings from 80 to 400, the Tech-Com DSC-520 is definitely not meant for a lot of indoor shooting, especially in areas where there isn't sufficient lighting.

As expected, photo quality outdoors was good, except at full optical zoom (3x) where some slight

graininess does creep in. Indoors, you'll be using a flash... a lot. The flash is good for around 9 feet, after which it loses effectiveness altogether. Indoor shots are decent quality, but the noise is noticeable. At 640 x 480 @ 15 fps, this digicam is also a decent video recorder.

At Rs 6,500, the Tech-Com DSC-520 is decent value for money, and for newbies making a foray into digital imaging, a good buy.

Specifications

5 megapixel CCD sensor; 3x optical zoom; 4x digital zoom; 2-inch LCD viewfinder; ISO manual 80-400 and auto; self-timer 2/10 sec; AA batteries

Contact: Shree Sagarmatha Dist. Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022-23065114 / 23200032
E-mail: techcom@airtelbroadband.in
Website: www.techcomindia.com
Price: Rs. 6,500

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Over all	★★★★

Access Digital Photo Frame

Frame From The Future



Here's a unique way to, well, frame your memories. The Access Digital Photo Frame has the ability to store images and display them on its 7-inch frame, transferred from your PC or digicam via USB or memory card. Remote-controlled, it looks

just like your average photo frame.

It is supported by a desk stand, but can also be hung on a wall. But the frame can only be placed horizontally, requiring you to rotate your portrait-style images before transferring them to the device.

In addition to image slideshows, it also supports MP3 and video. Larger images larger are automatically resized.

Niggles: the hard buttons on the remote, and the lack of crispness in darker images.

Specifications

7-inch 480 x 234 display; inbuilt stereo output; USB 1.0/2.0; CF card slot; memory card slot (MS, SD, MMC XD)

Contact: ACCESS Co. Ltd
Phone: 022-23840789
E-mail: cshah@bom8.vsnl.net.in
Price: Rs. 10,500

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Over all	★★★★

World Travel Products Podera

Launch USB 2.0 4-port hub

Standard, Yet Pricy

Splashed in red, this USB Shub offers four USB 2.0 ports. You connect it to a free USB port on your computer, and you get four ports—useful, in fact essential, if you have more USB devices than ports.

The Podera Launch weighs just 115 gm and is compact. The four ports are placed vertically in columns of two on opposite sides. The hub has a base, and the part above it can be turned for 30 degrees for easy accessi-

bility to the ports.

Installing the hub is just a matter of plugging it in, and confirming the status light at the bottom is on; you can then

get started using it. The status light could have been placed better for easier visibility, though.

At Rs 1,625, this one is a little expensive, considering most 4-port hubs can be had for less than Rs 1,000.

Specifications

75 x 75 x 63 mm; 80 cm cable length; four USB 2.0 ports compatible with USB 1.1

Contact: J. S. Equipments
Phone: 022-23810713
E-mail: jse@vsnl.com
Price: Rs. 1,625

RATINGS	
Performance	★★★★
Features	★★★★
Ease of use	★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★
Over all	★★★★